Travis G. Kim

traviskim2029@u.northwestern.edu | (925) 436-9570 | website | linkedin

Last updated 26 October 2026

Education

Exp. June 2029 **Northwestern University** *Evanston, IL*
B.A. in Philosophy & Cognitive Science, *Minor in Computer Science*
GPA 3.975. Relevant coursework: Introduction to Artificial Intelligence (CS 348), Philosophy of Mind (PHIL 325), Data Structures & Algorithms (CS 208).

Oct. 2026–Dec. 2026 **BlueDot Impact** *Remote*
Courses: AGI Strategy; Technical AI Safety (in progress)

Research Experience

Sep. 2026– **SPAR (Supervised Program for Alignment Research)** *Remote*
Research Fellow, *Alignment without Personas*

- Building an empirical power (ability to achieve a wide variety of actions) measurement framework durable across multiple agentic LLM tasks and environments to address long-horizon misalignment with the theory of change that RL against swings in impact will lead to a meek, misalignment avoidant model.
- Growing general knowledge on theories of change for alignment, control, and AI Safety.

Oct. 2026– **Mercial AI Safety Initiative** *Remote*
Facilitator

- Facilitating an LLM behavioral evaluation study for three researchers to create a tractable metric for scoring long-horizon agentic evaluation suites across various models in order to apply psychometric latent-variable analysis for testing generalizable characteristics of alignment to challenge top-down alignment assumptions like Anthropic's HHH model.

Nov. 2025– **SoundBrain Lab, Communication Sciences and Disorders, Northwestern University** *Evanston, IL*
Research Assistant

- Implemented and managed behavioral and electroencephalographic (EEG) experiments with 5-figure budgets to identify tractable perceptual mechanisms and effective learning paradigms for AI-speech detection, laying the foundation for further studies to address the scarcity of human-based deepfake awareness amidst a worsening climate of AI-enabled fraud.
- Organized 1,000 hours worth of EEG data using Python's MNE package to pre-train an open-source speech brain foundation model to be used as a scalable benchmark for attended-talker decoding, enabling heightened levels of clarity to hearing aid users.
- Analyzed and communicated response data through statistical methods from signal detection theory and decision bound modeling to identify effective AI-speech detection pedagogy, resulting in a forthcoming publication.

Sep. 2026– **Design, Technology, and Research (DTR)** *Evanston, IL*
Student Researcher

- Developed and implemented theoretical framework for Dialectical Search, an LLM-based coaching prototype aiding people's engagement with a new activity by reframing computable activity support from one offering short term advice to one suggesting user-specific long-term engagement strategies grounded in the theory of Talbot Brewer's dialectical activities and Agnes Callard's proleptic reasons.
- Prepared IRB protocol and Undergraduate Research Grant proposal for a multi-week human-subjects study to support 25 individuals in engaging in new activities using this intervention.

May 2026– **Cochlear Implant Sound Quality Matching** *Evanston, IL*
Research Collaborator

- Built audio plugin chains based on digital audio workstation REAPER to streamline experimental cochlear-implant sound quality matching process into a web app with fine-grained user control and robust save states, cutting experiment time from 3 hours to 1.
- Designed behavioral experiment exploring perceptual descriptions of filter manipulations on recorded speech with intended reach of 100 participants.

Jul. 2026– Sep. 2026 **SURG, Northwestern Office of Undergraduate Research** *Evanston, IL*
Grant Recipient

- Explored the philosophical implications of essentializing humanity in a world of ubiquitous technology in a 50-page novella, reflecting upon present day rapid advancements in computing technology.
- Theorized work in terms of posthuman theory (Deleuze and Guattari, Haraway) and techno-Orientalism.

Nov. 2025– Apr. 2026 **Experimental Meaning Group, Department of Linguistics** *Evanston, IL*
Research Assistant
Ensured quality eye tracking data collection on >20 participants to reveal the implications of mismatched gendered adjectives on real-time sentence processing, drawing on theoretical frameworks from syntax, semantics, and morphology.

Honors, Grants & Fellowships

2025–2026 Dean's List (3×), Northwestern University: December 2025, March 2026, and June 2026

May 2026 Summer Undergraduate Research Grant (SURG), Northwestern Office of Undergraduate Research, and Cognitive Science Summer Undergraduate Research Fellowship, Northwestern Cognitive Science Program (voice clone detection research) — received both $4,000 grants but could accept only one

Mar. 2026 Northwestern Center for Leadership Grant ($5,000) — awarded to Barbell Club to make full-scale powerlifting meets accessible to students

Sep. 2025 Kaplan Humanities Scholars Program, Northwestern University — 1 of 42 first-year students selected for an intensive interdisciplinary humanities program; seminar: *Gender, Trans, and All That Comes After*

Publications

Research

Forthcoming Roark, C. L., **Kim, T.**, Guo, Z., Groh, M., & Chandrasekaran, B. Humans can learn to detect AI voice clones.

Creative

Forthcoming **Kim, T.** Old Delivery [Short story]. *Helicon Literary Magazine*, Spring 2026.

Mar. 2026 **Kim, T.** (2026). Confetti [Short story]. *Helicon Literary Magazine*, Winter 2026.

Presentations

May 2026 **Kim, T.** (2026, May). *Feedback-based Training and Musicality: Teaching People to Detect Deepfake Speech* [Poster presentation]. Northwestern Undergraduate Research Symposium, Evanston, IL. Scored 94%.

May 2026 **Kim, T.** (2026, May). *Feedback-based Training and Musicality: Teaching People to Detect Deepfake Speech* [Poster presentation]. Communication Sciences and Disorders Undergraduate Research Day, Northwestern University, Evanston, IL.

Teaching & Mentorship

Sep. 2026– **Northwestern AI Safety Group** *Evanston, IL*
Junior Leader, Technical Fellowship
Aided in the curricular development and facilitation of weekly AI Safety Technical fellowship upskilling Northwestern students on AI Safety fundamentals with intention to begin mech interp research project in 2027.

Jul. 2026 **Northwestern Department of Communication Sciences and Disorders** *Evanston, IL*
Research Facilitator
Designed curriculum for three high school researchers to learn about researching and designing the structure of a feedback-based category learning experiment within a one-month timeline resulting in the creation of an online behavioral experiment for AI speech recognition.

Sep. 2023– Aug. 2025 **Self-Employed** *Tri-Valley Area, CA*
Tutor
Tutored 10 students from grades 6–12 in all Math levels, History, English, Chemistry, Biology, SAT, and Spanish with one student raising a grade from failing to B+ and multiple students receiving A's in the subjects I tutored.

Leadership & Activities

Nov. 2025– **Barbell Club** *Evanston, IL*
Founder & President

- Directed the University's only general fitness organization, serving 100+ members, and fostering an inclusive gym community to promote health, consistency, and peer support for all students at Northwestern.
- Launched Northwestern's powerlifting team to represent the university at 4 national-level meets and recruited a world-champion head coach to offer free powerlifting training and support to over 10 competitive athletes.
- Received $5,000 from the Northwestern Center for Leadership supporting our club's initiative to improve accessibility to full scale powerlifting meets by reducing the cost of entry from ~$500 to $20.

Sep. 2025– **Korean American Student Association (KASA)** *Evanston, IL*
Outreach Chair

- Built multi-year partnerships with Chicagoland's largest Korean community organizations, including the Hanul Family Alliance, HANA Center, and KANWIN through educational events and volunteering initiatives, strengthening campus-community engagement.

- Organized programming for the annual KASA Show, a large-scale cultural showcase with over 500 attendees featuring performances and original skits; contributed to filming and scriptwriting.
- Coordinated outreach and logistics for guest speaker and author Min Jin Lee, facilitating her discussion with over 200 attendees.

Athletics

Apr. 2026 14th Place, Powerlifting America Collegiate Nationals

Sep. 2024 National Champion, USA Powerlifting Raw Nationals

Miscellaneous

Languages Korean (proficient), Spanish (intermediate)

Interests Designing and sewing clothes, photography, hiking, reading and writing (mostly fiction), powerlifting